

早稲田大学 英語 過去問風演習

長文読解 ー 本番想定 (大問 1 題・25 分)

2026年5月26日

高校3年～既卒 (早稲田大学 文系志望)

英語 (長文読解・早稲田本番レベル)

Trillion 塾

Reading Comprehension (25 min, 35 pts) [配点 35 点]

Read the following passage and answer the questions below.

The notion of "deep work" has gained considerable attention in recent years, championed by computer science professor Cal Newport. (A) Deep work, in his definition, refers to professional activities performed in a state of distraction-free concentration that push your cognitive capabilities to their limit. Such activities create new value, improve skills, and are hard to replicate. In an economy where shallow tasks are increasingly automated, the ability to focus deeply has become both rare and valuable.

Yet most modern workers find deep work elusive. Open-plan offices, constant notifications, and the social pressure to remain "available" via instant messaging have eroded our capacity for sustained concentration. Studies suggest that the average knowledge worker is interrupted every six minutes, and full recovery from each interruption takes nearly twenty-three minutes. The arithmetic is stark: most professionals never reach the state of deep work at all.

(B) What makes the situation paradoxical is that the very tools designed to make us more productive — email, Slack, smartphones — often make deep work impossible. The illusion of productivity that comes from rapid response to messages masks the absence of meaningful, lasting output. We feel busy without being effective.

Newport's prescription is severe but increasingly adopted by elite knowledge workers: schedule blocks of two to four hours per day during which all communication tools are switched off, and protect these blocks as you would a meeting with your most important client. (C) The goal is not to work more hours, but to work with such intensity that the hours you do put in produce results that would normally require twice or three times the time.

Critics argue that deep work is a privilege available only to those who can afford to ignore others. (D) Service-oriented professionals, parents of young children, and workers in collaborative cultures may struggle to find uninterrupted blocks. Newport acknowledges this, but counters that even partial implementation — protecting just one hour of focused work daily — can transform a career over years.

Whatever one's view, the underlying principle is hard to dismiss: in an age of perpetual distraction, the ability to think slowly, deeply, and continuously about difficult problems is the rarest of all professional skills. Those who cultivate it will find themselves disproportionately rewarded.

Notes:

deep work — 深い集中を要する作業

elusive — 捉えどころのない

prescription — 処方箋 / 提言

disproportionately — 不釣り合いに大きく

Reading Comprehension (25 min, 35 pts) — Questions

Q1 1

What is the main idea of the underlined sentence (A)?

- ① Deep work refers to any kind of professional activity that lasts a long time.
- ② Deep work is a state of focused concentration that develops valuable, hard-to-replicate skills.
- ③ Deep work means working multiple jobs at the same time.
- ④ Deep work is impossible in modern offices.

Q2 2

According to the passage, the average knowledge worker is interrupted every:

- ① twenty-three minutes
- ② six minutes
- ③ two hours
- ④ thirty minutes

Q3 3

What does the underlined sentence (B) suggest about modern productivity tools?

- ① They have made deep work universally accessible.
- ② Tools designed to boost productivity often prevent deep focus.
- ③ Email and Slack are the most efficient tools for deep work.
- ④ Modern tools have no impact on concentration.

Q4 4

What does Newport recommend, according to underlined sentence (C)?

- ① Working longer hours every day.
- ② Working with such intensity that fewer hours produce more results.
- ③ Eliminating all collaborative work.
- ④ Hiring assistants to handle communication.

Q5 5

What critique of deep work is presented in underlined sentence (D)?

- ① Deep work is too easy for most professionals.
- ② Deep work is a privilege not equally available to those with care responsibilities or collaborative roles.
- ③ Deep work eliminates the need for meetings.
- ④ Deep work is universally rejected by experts.

Q6 6

Which of the following best summarizes the author's conclusion?

- ① Deep work is no longer relevant in the modern age.
- ② Anyone can master deep work with sufficient effort.
- ③ The ability to focus deeply on difficult problems has become one of the most valuable professional skills.
- ④ Newport's theory has been disproven by recent studies.

Q7 7

The word 'elusive' in paragraph 2 most nearly means:

- ① exciting
- ② difficult to obtain or achieve
- ③ expensive
- ④ obvious

解答・解説

問	解答	解説
1	②	【正解】② 下線部 (A) は『深い集中状態で行う、認知能力を限界まで使う活動』を定義。これは「新しい価値を創造し、模倣困難なスキルを伸ばす」と直後の文で補足される。よって②が最も適切。
2	②	【正解】② 第2段落「interrupted every six minutes」と明記。23分は中断からの回復に必要な時間。
3	②	【正解】② 下線部 (B) は「生産性を高めるはずのツールが逆に深い集中を妨げる」というパラドックスを指摘。
4	②	【正解】② 下線部 (C) は明確に「より長く働くのではなく、より集中して働くことで、通常の2-3倍の時間が必要な結果を出す」と述べる。
5	②	【正解】② 下線部 (D) は「サービス業従事者・幼児の親・協調的な職場の労働者」を例示し、deep work が一部の人のみの特権である可能性を指摘。
6	③	【正解】③ 最終段落「the ability to think slowly, deeply, and continuously about difficult problems is the rarest of all professional skills」と一致。

問	解答	解説
7	②	【正解】 ② 'elusive' = 捉えどころのない / 達成しがたい。文脈「find deep work elusive」は「深い集中を達成しがたい」の意。